TEXT ANALYSIS FOR DATA SCIENCE · RESEARCH POSTER

Trump, Iran & the language of conflict

Six rhetorical frames before, on, and after selected conflict dates

Sean Ryan

NC State University · DSA 495

Final snapshot · November 3, 2026

UCDP through September 30

Principal finding

Opening-period Threat scores decline across event windows.

Opening event starts: 0.638 → 0.603 → 0.485 · before / event day / after

130	43	235	6
unique matched posts	conflict start dates	post / date pairs	rhetorical frames

01 Frame the project

How do rhetorical frames differ around conflict dates? Political posts mix threats, success claims, and negotiations. Comparing frames helps readers examine public messaging around selected events.

Task. Given an Iran-related post, compare six independent frame scores before, on, and after selected event starts; contrast opening-period and later starts.

02 Explain the workflow

1. **Collect & align**
   75 selected UCDP records; 43 start dates. Match original Iran-related posts by Eastern Time dates at −1, 0, +1 days.
2. **Prepare**
   Deduplicate by post ID; preserve saved text, case, and punctuation. One pair per post / event date.
3. **Represent & classify**
   BART tokenizer → contextual representations → `facebook/bart-large-mnli`. Six natural-language prompts; multi-label NLI; truncation enabled.
4. **Aggregate**
   Average within each date/window, then across date means. Compare opening-period starts (Feb 28–Mar 13) with later starts.

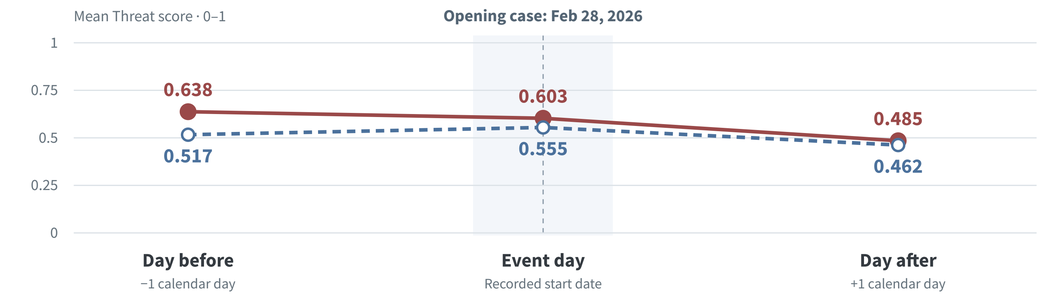
The model sees post text only. Event metadata and fatality totals do not enter the classifier. One post can score highly on several frames.

03 Show the results

Threat before, on and after event starts

Same 0–1 scale · same method

● **Opening two weeks** · starts Feb 28–Mar 13 ○ **Later dates** · starts Mar 14–Sep 2



Opening-period scores decline from before to after. Later dates rise on the event day, then fall.

Opening: 10 selected starts; 9 / 9 / 9 contributing dates. Later: 33 starts; 27 / 26 / 26 contributing dates (before / on / after). Equal date weights; missing windows omitted. Overlapping windows reuse posts. Scores are unvalidated; no uncertainty intervals or causal claim. Exact means & counts ↗

Six frames around selected event starts

All six frames · same 0–1 scale

All available posts · 36 / 35 / 35 contributing dates · 76 / 77 / 82 post-event pairs (before / event day / after)

Threat



Victory



Diplomacy



Ceasefire / Ending



Blame Allies



Media Criticism



Entailment scores, not calibrated probabilities or shares of posts. Lines connect window means; no uncertainty intervals are estimated. Different prompts can elicit different score levels.

04 Evaluate & reflect

Preliminary · human evaluation pending

Integrity checks passed. All 130 score IDs join to the corpus; six score columns are finite and in 0–1. Pairs are unique; saved date offsets match.

Accuracy is untested. No human gold labels, held-out precision/recall/F1, or evaluated baseline. Integrity checks do not validate rhetorical accuracy.

A failure mode to investigate

Donald J. Trump · 2026-03-27

> Going to make a big speech on economics in Miami. Our Military Operation in Iran is going GREAT! President DJT

The post praises the operation but does not explicitly say the fighting has ended.

Ceasefire / Ending **0.802**

Inspect source ↗ · Qualitative case, not a gold label.

Limits & practical implications

Window coverage differs; missing posts are not zero rhetoric. Overlapping windows reuse posts and create dependence.

Same-day dates cannot establish ordering. Linked headlines, missing media, and truncation can distort attribution.

Use scores to find language for human review. Human validation and non-event comparisons are needed before stronger claims.

Day before · 2026-02-27 · 0 posts

No matching post in the saved Iran-related corpus. No score assigned.

Event day · 2026-02-28 · 2 posts

Iran tried to interfere in 2020, 2024 elections to stop Trump, and now faces renewed war with United States: https://justthenews.com/government/security/iranians-tried-interfere-2020-and-2024-stop-trump-iran-now-faces-possible-war

Source ↗

Day after · 2026-03-01 · 5 posts

Iran just stated that they are going to hit very hard today, harder than they have ever been hit before. THEY BETTER NOT DO THAT, HOWEVER, BECAUSE IF THEY DO, WE WILL HIT THEM WITH A FORCE THAT HAS NEVER BEEN SEEN BEFORE! Thank you for your attention to this matter!…

Source ↗

Sources & reproducibility. Project repository, data & notebook · UCDP · BART-MNLI · Matching public-post archive. Frozen Nov 3: UCDP Candidate 26.01.26.09; pinned post archive through Nov 3. Legacy model revision remains unpinned; 40 new six-frame scores use a pinned BART revision. UCDP: CC BY 4.0; underlying post rights remain with their owners.